

Bedtime Tales

Holly the Hedgehog's Gentle Hug



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Holly was a small brown hedgehog who lived under a mossy log. She had soft fur on her tummy, but her back was covered in sharp little prickles. She loved her friends very much — Monty the mouse, Fern the frog — but she never gave hugs, afraid her prickles would poke. "I would hurt them," she whispered. She wanted to hug more than anything, and that made her sad.



One afternoon, Monty the mouse came to visit with blackberry jam sandwiches. "Thank you for sharing your log with me," he said. Then he opened his arms wide. "Can I have a hug, Holly?"



Holly's heart went thump thump. Her prickles stood up straight with fear. "I might poke you," she said.



Monty smiled. "We will find a gentle way," he said. "Gentle and slow, that's the way to go."



"Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." Holly repeated it softly.
"Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." It became their special saying.



Monty showed her a trick. "First, I hug your soft tummy side," he explained. "Then you wrap your little arms around me. And we go gentle and slow."



Holly tried it. She turned her soft side toward Monty and wrapped her arms around him. Gentle and slow. It worked! No pokes at all — just a warm, cozy hug. "I did it!" she squeaked, feeling happy and brave.



Can you give yourself a gentle hug? Wrap your arms around you, gentle and slow. Just like Holly.



Next, Fern the frog hopped over. "Hug for me too?" she asked. Holly nodded and used her trick again. Gentle and slow. Fern giggled. "Best hug ever," she said. Holly hugged all her friends that day, each hug gentle and slow.



That night, the moon rose round and bright. Holly curled into a ball under her log while Monty snuggled beside her, safe from prickles. "Goodnight, gentle hugger," he whispered. Holly smiled in her sleep and dreamed of soft hugs, warm and slow. And she slept the whole night through.

There is always a gentle way to
show someone you love them.

The End

